

REFERENCE CARD

Technical secondary and vocational orientation

What has worked, in the region and outside it, for the two axes the viceministra named, plus what works in youth employment for the MTPE room. Each case in two sentences: how it works, and what it delivered.



§ 01 ·

WHY THIS CARD

On 30 August, viceministra de Gestión Pedagógica **Miriam Ponce** published the sector's working agenda: update the curriculum, **strengthen technical secondary**, align CETPRO and institutes with productive demand, and **reinforce vocational orientation** and the COAR. This card carries the evidence for the two axes where the Bank can offer something concrete this week.

§ 02 ·

VOCATIONAL ORIENTATION: THE CHEAP LEVER

Peru, MineduLAB: Decidiendo para un Futuro Mejor. Cómo funciona: the ministry's own innovation lab, with IPA, showed short videos on the real returns to finishing school, inside class hours, right before students decide. **Impacto:** lower dropout at a marginal cost of **S/ 0,20 per student**, with the potential to keep more than 25,000 students in school, and better ECE mathematics scores in Junín and Áncash. **This ministry already proved the idea;** the AI career coach is the same idea, ten years on.

Dominican Republic (Jensen, QJE 2010). Cómo funciona: students dramatically underestimated what finishing school pays; the trial simply told them the measured returns. **Impacto:** more completed years of schooling from information alone. The founding result behind every returns-information programme since.

Mexico, returns information in upper secondary (Avitabile and de Hoyos). Cómo funciona: a randomised trial gave students facts on returns and on how to finance further study. **Impacto:** mathematics learning rose by about a tenth of a standard deviation: students who see why school pays work harder at it.

§ 03 ·

TECHNICAL SECONDARY: THE DESIGNS THAT DELIVERED

Korea, Meister high schools. Cómo funciona: 52 technical schools designed with industry inside: firms co-write the curriculum, practitioners teach, and hiring agreements are part of the model. **Impacto:** graduate employment above **90% in 2013 to 2017**, and still the top of the system: 73,1% employed against 52,4% for specialised schools and 38,2% for vocational tracks in general schools, with the best one-year job retention (71,5%).

Switzerland and Germany, the dual system. Cómo funciona: students split the week between classroom and a paid apprenticeship in a firm, across 250 occupations; the firm is a co-educator, not a destination. **Impacto:** two thirds of Swiss young people choose this route, and Switzerland holds one of the lowest youth unemployment rates in the OECD. The lesson that travels is the design, not the wealth.

Mexico, CONALEP's dual model. Cómo funciona: the German design adapted to a middle-income system since 2013: alternance between school and firm under formal agreements between colleges and companies. **Impacto:** dual-track students show **better grades, attendance, completion and university admission** than the traditional track. Proof the dual idea survives translation to Latin America.

Colombia, Jóvenes en Acción (Attanasio, Kugler and Meghir). Cómo funciona: for the CETPRO axis: three months of classroom technical training plus three months of in-firm practice, delivered by private providers paid for placement. **Impacto:** a randomised trial found higher formal employment and earnings, around **20% for women**, with effects persisting years later.

§ 04 ·

WHAT THE BANK CAN PUT ON THE TABLE THIS WEEK

A **comparative technical note** on Meister, the dual system and CONALEP, with a design for a Peruvian technical-secondary or COAR pilot. A **revival of the MineduLAB orientation line**, now with AI, through the career coach already running in 110 schools. And a **working session with the viceministra's teams** to choose the entry point, which is exactly the technical meeting the mission asks for.

SOURCES

1. MineduLAB, *Decidiendo para un Futuro Mejor*, policy brief · <http://www.minedu.gob.pe/minedulab/pdf/n-06-pb-decidiendo-para-un-futuro-mejor-final-2019.pdf>
2. Meister high schools, IDB Education blog, and labour-market gaps, Cogent Education 2023 · <https://www.iadb.org/en/blog/education/meister-high-schools-south-korean-model-revitalize-technical-and-vocational-education>
3. CONALEP, *La experiencia en la Formación Dual* · https://www.gob.mx/cms/uploads/attachment/file/291188/La_experiencia_del_CONALEP_en_la_Formacion_Dual_VF_.pdf
4. Swiss VET, OECD country study · https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/vocational-education-and-training-systems-in-nine-countries_1a86eb6c-en/full-report/vocational-education-and-training-in-switzerland_051e4a43.html
5. Jensen 2010 QJE; Avitabile and de Hoyos; Attanasio, Kugler and Meghir · *literature, full citations on request*

§ 05 ·

YOUTH EMPLOYMENT: WHAT THE EVIDENCE SAYS, FOR THE MTPE ROOM

The honest opener (McKenzie, World Bank Research Observer). Cómo funciona: a critical review of the trials on training, wage subsidies and job-search programmes in developing countries. **Impacto:** most active labour-market policies deliver much less than assumed. The Bank saying this first is what makes the next cases credible.

Colombia, Jóvenes en Acción. Cómo funciona: three months of technical classroom training plus three months of in-firm practice, private providers paid for placement. **Impacto:** sustained gains in formal employment and earnings, around 20% for women, persisting years later. The regional benchmark for training that works.

Côte d'Ivoire, subsidised dual apprenticeships. Cómo funciona: the state subsidises apprenticeship places inside firms, formalising learning that was already happening informally. **Impacto:** more access to training, higher skills and earnings, and apprentices taking on more complex tasks. The dual idea working in a lower-income setting.

Information and matching, the cheap end. Cómo funciona: job-search assistance, help signalling skills to employers, and better career information before the choice. **Impacto:** consistently cost-effective across trials; and it is the layer Eligiendo Mi Camino already delivers, one step earlier, before the first decision is taken.

§ 06 ·

THE ES HOY PROPOSALS, FROM THE FORUM WHERE PAZ AND PONCE SHARED THE STAGE

EncontrarNos por el Perú (Es Hoy and Apoyo Consultoría) published four proposals for the first hundred days: a **tax incentive for the first formal youth job**; **dual training** designed with firms; **strengthening Mi Carrera**, the MTPE's career-information platform, with permanently updated data; and **scholarships by taxes** channelled through Pronabec. Two of the four are doors this mission can walk through: Mi Carrera is the natural home for the career coach, and dual training is the technical note already offered to MINEDU.

SOURCES

1. McKenzie 2017, How effective are active labour market policies in developing countries · <https://academic.oup.com/wbro/article/32/2/127/4064175>
2. World Bank 2025, Making Labor Markets Work for the Youth, approach paper · <https://documents1.worldbank.org/curated/en/099021125104529845/pdf/P506693-6eb8104a-0f5f-43e4-ab0b-7017bd23765a.pdf>
3. World Bank SIEF, Active Labor Markets and Youth Employment · <https://www.worldbank.org/en/programs/sief-trust-fund/brief/active-labor-markets-and-youth-employment>
4. EncontrarNos por el Perú, youth-employment proposals · <https://www.apoyoconsultoria.com/es/empleo-juvenil-esta-es-la-prioridad-de-los-primeros-100-dias-del-nuevo-gobierno/>